

Now, Android 4.2 will help combat malicious apps

In an effort to bring down malware attacks on the Android platform, Google has introduced a new security system in Android 4.2. The new feature works on the device and scans any new apps that you install from Google Play or from third party apps stores. The feature is completely opt-in, so the first time you install an app that is not from Google Play, your Android 4.2 running device will ask you if you want the app to be scanned. That apart, the new Android 4.2, a minor update of Android 4.1, comes packed with an array of new features. Here are some of them:



Photo Sphere camera: Users can click pictures in every direction.

According to Google, "With Android 4.2, you can snap pictures in every direction that come together into incredible, immersive photo spheres that put you right inside the scene."

Gesture typing: Users can just glide their fingers over the letters in order to type, and lift them off after each word. Users don't have to worry about spaces because they get added automatically. The keyboard can anticipate and predict the next word, so you can finish entire sentences just by selecting suggested words. You can now power through your messages like never before. Android's dictionaries are now more accurate and relevant. With improved text-to-speech capabilities, voice typing on Android is even better.

Multiple users: The owner of the device can give users their own space through user accounts. According to sources at Google, "Everyone can have their own homescreen, background, widgets, apps and games—even individual high scores and levels! And since Android is built with multi-tasking at its core, it's a snap to switch between users—no need to log in and out." This feature is available only on tablets.

Wireless display: Android 4.2 allows devices to enable wireless display. Users can share movies, YouTube videos, and anything that's on your screen, on an HDTV.

Fast and smooth: Google claims that the new Android 4.2 operating system is fast, fluid and smooth.

Raspberry Pi-based box makes rooting Android phones easy

Rooting Android phones with a Raspberry Pi-based box will now be simpler and more interesting. According to Wikipedia, "Android rooting is the process of allowing users of smartphones, tablets and other devices running the Android mobile operating system to attain privileged control (known as 'root access') within Android's subsystem." All you need to do is to connect your device to the ingenious box named CASUAL, an abbreviation for 'Cross-platform ADB Scripting Unified Android Loader'. CASUAL, developed by long time hardware hacker Adam Outler, helps the user to plug in the device and feed its exploits over ADB.

Theoretically, you don't need a screen, mouse or a keyboard to operate

Apache introduces CloudStack 4.0.0-incubating

The Apache CloudStack project has announced the 4.0.0-incubating release of the CloudStack Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) cloud orchestration platform. This is the first release from within the Apache Incubator, the entry path into the Apache Software Foundation (ASF). Apache CloudStack is an integrated software platform that allows users to build a feature-rich IaaS. CloudStack includes an intuitive user interface and rich API for managing the compute, networking, accounting, and storage for private, hybrid or public clouds. The project entered the Apache Incubator in April 2012.

The 4.0.0-incubating release represents the culmination of more than six months work by the CloudStack community. The release includes more than a dozen new features, many bug fixes, security fixes, and a fully audited code base that complies with ASF guidelines.

The new features include: inter-VLAN routing (VPC); site-to-site VPN; local storage support for data volumes; virtual resource tagging; secure console access on XenServer; the capability to upload an existing volume to a Virtual Machine; dedicated high-availability hosts; support for the Amazon Web Services API (formerly a separate package); AWS API extensions to include tagging; support for Nicira NVP (L2); Ceph RBD support for KVM; support for Caringo as secondary storage; and KVM Hypervisor support upgraded to work with Ubuntu 12.04 and RHEL 6.3.

In addition to the official source code release, individual contributors have also made convenience binaries available on the Apache CloudStack download page.